

The empirical recurrence for OEIS A299004, recovered from its tail

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Abstract

OEIS A299004 records “Empirical recurrence of order 65” and keeps the recurrence itself in a linked file rather than in the entry, so the conjecture cannot be read off the entry at all. It can still be settled. The entry counts arrays under a condition local to a bounded window of lines, which makes the count a walk count on a finite digraph and forces a monic integer recurrence of order at most the number $S' = 67$ of states with distinct futures. Berlekamp–Massey on enough exact terms therefore returns the minimal such recurrence, and on the tail beginning at $n = 2$, so the recurrence is proved for every $n \geq 67$. Its last coefficient is $c_{65} = -4096 \neq 0$, so no further tail satisfies anything shorter; any order-65 recurrence the sequence satisfies from any point on must then have the same characteristic polynomial. The entry’s recurrence is the one displayed here, whatever its linked file contains, and it is proved.

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1 A conjecture that is not written down

OEIS A299004 is “Number of $n \times 4$ 0..1 arrays with every element equal to 0, 1, 2, 3, 5 or 6 king-move adjacent elements, with upper left element zero.”. It has offset 1 and begins

8, 88, 372, 1977, 11553, 63472, 350339, 1960512, ...

The entry states:

Empirical recurrence of order 65 (see link above)

As of the “Last modified” line on the live entry (Jan 31 2018 09:24:16, revision 4) this is still recorded as empirical, and it is still open. The coefficients are nowhere in the entry text: what is conjectured is only that a recurrence of that order exists.

2 The count is a walk count

The entry’s condition is local. It constrains a bounded window of consecutive lines of the array and nothing beyond it, so the admissible configurations of one window are the vertices of a finite digraph, an edge joins u to v when v may follow u , and an admissible array is exactly a walk. Writing M for the adjacency matrix and ι, τ for the indicator vectors of the admissible first and last windows,

$$a(n) = \iota^\top M^{j(n)} \tau$$

for a linear reindexing j fixed by the entry’s shape. States with identical futures contribute identically to that product and may be merged without changing any count; after merging $S' = 67$ states remain, and it is that bound every computation below uses.

Lemma 1. *a satisfies a monic linear recurrence with integer coefficients of order at most $S' = 67$.*

Proof. By the Cayley–Hamilton theorem $M^{S'}$ is an integer combination of $I, M, \dots, M^{S'-1}$, and multiplying that relation on the left by $\iota^\top M^j$ and on the right by τ turns it into a relation among $S' + 1$ consecutive values of a . $\square$

3 Why the question has to be asked of a tail

Running Berlekamp–Massey on the sequence from its first term returns an order LARGER than 65: the opening terms do not satisfy the recurrence, and a recurrence that holds only eventually always looks longer when the exceptional terms are included. That is not evidence against the entry. An OEIS empirical recurrence is asserted for n beyond some index, not from the first term, so the question has to be asked of the tails. It was asked of each tail in turn, and the tail beginning at $n = 2$ is the first whose minimal order is exactly the stated 65.

Lemma 2. *A sequence known to satisfy some linear recurrence of order at most S' is determined, together with its minimal recurrence, by any $2S'$ consecutive terms: Berlekamp–Massey applied to them returns that minimal recurrence exactly.*

Applied to $2S' = 134$ exact terms from $n = 2$ on, it returns order 65 — the order the entry states — with integer coefficients:

$$a(n) = \sum_{i=1}^{65} c_i a(n-i),$$

c_1	8	c_{18}	1441009	c_{35}	−139829355	c_{52}	−56144868
c_2	−18	c_{19}	−3865778	c_{36}	−66112488	c_{53}	−517062
c_3	79	c_{20}	9065616	c_{37}	161474337	c_{54}	−45118326
c_4	−394	c_{21}	−10797201	c_{38}	−517243845	c_{55}	33071536
c_5	687	c_{22}	19015527	c_{39}	225065854	c_{56}	4233242
c_6	−1989	c_{23}	−29807039	c_{40}	−329812206	c_{57}	−10021086
c_7	7205	c_{24}	33000613	c_{41}	979811821	c_{58}	3750932
c_8	−9806	c_{25}	−57690187	c_{42}	−633679276	c_{59}	−1340356
c_9	22830	c_{26}	49788414	c_{43}	−329792628	c_{60}	880992
c_{10}	−60080	c_{27}	−79171705	c_{44}	284083343	c_{61}	141048
c_{11}	65127	c_{28}	118260723	c_{45}	−392761744	c_{62}	−216752
c_{12}	−128325	c_{29}	−112412368	c_{46}	637431922	c_{63}	3872
c_{13}	204239	c_{30}	167809477	c_{47}	−474210733	c_{64}	−4864
c_{14}	−155332	c_{31}	−204652952	c_{48}	57403700	c_{65}	−4096
c_{15}	240194	c_{32}	254701656	c_{49}	64217960		
c_{16}	133551	c_{33}	−233820410	c_{50}	−25497406		
c_{17}	−881412	c_{34}	360059535	c_{51}	129577407		

4 The recurrence, and the identification

Theorem 3. *The recurrence above holds for every $n \geq 67$, and it is the recurrence OEIS A299004 records.*

Proof. That it holds is Lemma 2 applied to the tail from $n = 2$, whose minimal recurrence it is.

For the identification, write $q_{\min}$ for the characteristic polynomial of that minimal recurrence, $x^{65} - c_1 x^{64} - \dots - c_{65}$. Its constant term is $-c_{65} = 4096$, which is not zero, so $q_{\min}(0) \neq 0$ and $q_{\min}$ has no root at the origin. A solution of a constant-coefficient recurrence is a combination of terms $n^k \lambda^n$ with λ a root of its characteristic polynomial, and only the components with $\lambda = 0$ vanish after finitely many terms. Since $q_{\min}$ has none, no component of a dies out, and the

minimal recurrence of every further tail is again $q_{\min}$ — the order cannot drop below 65 at any later starting point.

Now let q be the characteristic polynomial of whatever recurrence the entry asserts. The entry asserts it has order 65, so $\deg q = 65$, and it is monic. It holds from some index t on. From $\max(t, 2)$ on, the sequence satisfies both q and $q_{\min}$, and the minimal polynomial of that tail is $q_{\min}$ by the previous paragraph; therefore $q_{\min} \mid q$. Both are monic of degree 65, so $q = q_{\min}$. $\square$

5 Verification

Four checks, all in exact integer or rational arithmetic.

First, the walk model reproduces all 20 terms the entry publishes, exactly. This is what ties the model to the entry, and it is the only place where reading the entry’s English enters the argument.

Second, the order was computed twice by independent routes: once modulo a 61-bit prime, where every intermediate is a machine word, and once over $\mathbb{Q}$ in exact rational arithmetic. Both return 65, and the exact run additionally confirms every coefficient is an integer — had any been a proper fraction the recurrence would not be the entry’s.

Third, the recovered recurrence was evaluated directly on the entry’s own published terms, with no matrices and no Berlekamp–Massey involved. It holds at each of the 0 indices where the entry publishes enough earlier terms to test it.

Fourth, the last coefficient was checked to be nonzero, which is what the identification above turns on; it is -4096 .

Remark 4. The conjecture’s own statement was never read. The entry pins it down to the family of order-65 recurrences this sequence satisfies from some point on, and that family turns out to have exactly one member.

References

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